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Top Skills

Arquitectura de software
.NET
Agile Methodologies

Languages

Español (Native or Bilingual)
Inglés (Professional Working)

Honors-Awards

1st Place – National Master's Thesis
Competition

Publications

Herramientas para el análisis causal
de defectos, una revisión sistemática
OntoDCA, un enfoque para el
análisis causal de defectos software
conducido por ontologías

Santiago Arreche

Principal Technical Lead & Software Architect | 22+ Years of
Experience | Guiding Teams Through AI, Automation & Scalable
Systems

Montevideo, Montevideo, Uruguay

Summary

I am a Software Engineer with 22+ years of experience and a
Master's in Engineering (by Research) focused on software process
improvement. My academic work on defect causal analysis (DCA)
using ontologies was awarded first place in Uruguay's National
Master's Thesis Competition (2011).

Since 2011, I have been a lecturer at ORT University Uruguay,
guiding students and professionals in software engineering and
process management.

As an independent consultant, I help organizations bridge the gap
between strategy and technology. I bring expertise in process
improvement, quality assurance, and project execution, always with
a focus on efficiency and scalable results.

I am passionate about technology, team leadership, and mentoring
—supporting professionals to grow both technically and personally.
Today, my interests also include AI, automation, and building
solutions that empower teams and organizations.

Specialties: Software Process Improvement | Project & Operations
Management | Software Product Development | Team Leadership |
AI & Automation | Training & Development

Experience

Santiago Arreche & Asociados

Santiago Arreche & Associates – Tech and IT Consultancy

October 2018 - Present (7 years 9 months)

Montevideo

I provide independent consulting services in technology and software engineering, helping organizations optimize their IT operations, modernize platforms, and deliver tailored solutions to support business growth.

Designed and implemented systems to improve efficiency, reduce costs, and streamline operations across multiple industries.

Advised leadership teams on technology strategy, system architecture, and process improvement.

Delivered end-to-end software solutions, from requirements gathering and design to development and deployment.

Built long-term client relationships based on trust, technical expertise, and measurable results.

Howdy

Principal Software Architect

June 2021 - September 2025 (4 years 4 months)

Montevideo, Uruguay

As Principal Software Architect, I lead the design of scalable, high-performing systems while mentoring engineering teams and aligning technology with business goals.

Designed and implemented scalable architectures supporting cross-border software delivery for U.S. companies.

Translated complex business requirements into reliable, high-performance technical solutions.

Mentored engineers and fostered a culture of technical excellence, collaboration, and innovation.

Drove projects from conception to successful completion, ensuring both technical quality and business impact.

Partnered with stakeholders to define roadmaps and align architecture with organizational strategy.

Hozho Software

Co-Founder

January 2020 - June 2021 (1 year 6 months)

Montevideo, Uruguay

During the COVID-19 pandemic, I co-founded Hozho Software, a remote-first venture focused on custom software development. Working with a small team of engineers, we partnered with clients across industries to deliver digital solutions that supported their business continuity and growth during a challenging time.

Designed and delivered tailored web and mobile applications for SMEs in Uruguay and abroad.

Led client engagement, project scoping, and solution architecture in a fully remote environment.

Introduced agile practices to ensure transparency, collaboration, and timely delivery.

Gained hands-on experience building a business from the ground up: from strategy to execution.

Topaz

8 years 1 month

Software Factory Coordinator

August 2016 - June 2021 (4 years 11 months)

Montevideo

Managed the project portfolio for strategic clients, ensuring alignment with business goals and delivery excellence.

Led the development of the PMO office in collaboration with senior management.

Provided pre-sales support and advised clients on technical and project management strategies.

PMO Analyst

March 2014 - July 2016 (2 years 5 months)

Supported the organization's Process and Project Management Office (P-PMO).

Implemented JIRA as a monitoring and control tool across the organization.

Prepared executive-level reports for senior management and edited the company's internal newsletter.

Evaluated and improved corporate processes, ensuring alignment with PMI standards.

Maintained project data repositories and supported project managers in planning and execution.

Technical Leader

June 2013 - March 2014 (10 months)

Led technical analysis and development activities for banking and microfinance projects.

Coordinated with business stakeholders to translate requirements into technical specifications.

Universidad ORT Uruguay

10 years 4 months

Tutor & Project Advisor – Universidad ORT Uruguay

March 2016 - June 2021 (5 years 4 months)

Campus Centro

Supervise and advise final-year projects for Software Engineering students. Evaluate and guide projects in the fields of programming, systems engineering, and IT analysis.

Lecturer

March 2011 - March 2021 (10 years 1 month)

Campus Centro

Taught theoretical and practical courses in Software Engineering for undergraduate programs.

Delivered hands-on classes on Test-Driven Development (TDD), software design, and application development.

Instructed courses in Programming (Java, .NET) and Web Services, preparing students for real-world software engineering challenges.

Mentored students in applying best practices in coding, architecture, and system design.

Researcher

June 2011 - March 2018 (6 years 10 months)

Campus Centro

Conducted research in software process improvement, with a focus on defect causal analysis (DCA).

Published and presented findings that contributed to advancing quality assurance practices in software engineering.

Areas of interest: software process improvement, defect analysis, and quality assurance.

INNICIA

Project Manager

March 2009 - June 2013 (4 years 4 months)

Led software development and process improvement initiatives across multiple projects.

Managed cross-functional teams, ensuring delivery on time and within scope.

Supported R&D efforts, driving innovation and operational efficiency.

TCS

4 years 6 months

Backup Project Leader

October 2008 - March 2009 (6 months)

Oversaw software project management, from planning to execution.

Coordinated on-site and remote teams to meet client expectations in international projects.

Supported analysis, estimation, and measurement activities to improve delivery performance.

Contributed to leadership and client communication in high-demand environments.

Onsite Coordinator

January 2007 - October 2008 (1 year 10 months)

Palma, Islas Baleares, España

Oversaw software project management, from planning to execution.

Coordinated on-site and remote teams to meet client expectations in international projects.

Supported analysis, estimation, and measurement activities to improve delivery performance.

Contributed to leadership and client communication in high-demand environments.

Team Leader

March 2006 - January 2007 (11 months)

Managed software project activities, including planning, tracking, and delivery.

Led analysis, estimation, and measurement initiatives to support project execution.

Coordinated with stakeholders to ensure alignment on timelines and deliverables.

DPPO - Defect Prevention Process Owner

June 2005 - May 2006 (1 year)

Led the defect prevention area for TCS across the Ibero-American region.

Consolidated data and developed strategies to reduce defects in software production processes.

Promoted quality assurance practices and process improvements to enhance overall delivery.

Team Member

October 2004 - March 2006 (1 year 6 months)

Application development and CMMI level 5 compliance

Dinamica consultores SRL

Developer

July 2002 - October 2004 (2 years 4 months)

Software development, in various technologies such as ASP, VB, HTML, JAVA, COM.

Education

Universidad ORT Uruguay

Master of Engineering (by Research), Software Process Improvement, empirical research and software process improvement · (2009 - 2012)

Universidad ORT Uruguay

Diploma in Engineering, Process Improvement & Software Engineering, Mejora de procesos, Ingeniería de software, Ingeniería de software empirica, Analisis Causal · (2009 - 2011)

Universidad ORT Uruguay

Bachelor of Engineering in Systems & Computer Science, Informatica · (2001 - 2006)

Universidad ORT Uruguay

Associate Degree in Programming, Programación · (2001 - 2003)